

August 2026

Dear Clifford R,

I've worked this stretch of Lafayette for a long time, and the homes along Walnut Lane have always stood out to me for exactly the kind of thing your property delivers: a serious lot, real privacy, and a setting that feels removed from the noise without being far from anything. The combination of mature oaks, park-like grounds, and a cul-de-sac position is genuinely rare at any price point. When I saw the listing come off the market at 69 days without a sale, I wanted to reach out, because in my view the home's fundamentals and the outcome simply don't add up.

What the listing history tells me is that buyers weren't given the full picture. A farmhouse-style home on a half-acre lot with updated chef's kitchen, four bedrooms, and indoor-outdoor flow to gardens, patios, and a deck at \$1,995,000 is a compelling offering in Lafayette. But at \$904 per square foot, which sits at the upper tier of the Lafayette premium range, buyers need a fully built case before they'll walk in the door. The listing description made the right moves in spirit, but it leaned on phrases like 'seamlessly' and 'effortless entertaining' when buyers at this price point are comparison-shopping carefully. The grounds, the oak canopy, the views, the cul-de-sac privacy, and the trail access to Las Trampas and the Lafayette-Orinda Trail deserved to be the headline, not a footnote near the bottom of the remarks.

I've put together a short packet that walks through the three specific gaps I see between this home's actual value and how the listing presented it, along with how I'd approach a relaunch differently. There's no obligation attached to it. I just think you deserve a clear read on what happened and what a better strategy would look like.

If you're already working with an agent toward a new listing, please feel free to set this aside with my compliments. If you're not, I'd welcome a conversation whenever the timing feels right for you.

With respect,

A handwritten signature in blue ink, appearing to read "Ben Olsen", with a long horizontal line extending to the right.

Ben Olsen

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The Path to Sold:

3348 Walnut Ln

Lafayette, CA 94549

4.0 Beds · 3 Baths · 2,208 Sq Ft · Lafayette

The Blueprint for a Successful Sale

Prepared For: The Owners of 3348 Walnut Ln

Presented By: Ben Olsen · BrightWork Realty Advocates

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

A Park-Like Half-Acre with Farmhouse Character - and a Listing That Left the Story Half-Told

3348 Walnut Lane sits on 21,340 square feet of oak-canopied grounds on a quiet Lafayette cul-de-sac, with four bedrooms, three bathrooms, a chef's kitchen with breakfast bar, wood-burning fireplace, custom built-ins, and multiple access points opening to gardens, patios, and a deck. The trail proximity to Las Trampas Swim Club and the Lafayette-Orinda Trail, combined with top-rated Lafayette schools, puts this home in the conversation for exactly the buyers who move from San Francisco and Oakland specifically for this kind of lifestyle. These are real, marketable assets. The kind that support a premium price when the marketing does its job.

At \$904 per square foot on a 69-day listing that ended without a sale, the gap between the fundamentals and the outcome points to a strategy problem, not a property problem. The listing description touched on the right features but never built the argument for the price. Buyers comparing at this level need to understand what they're getting that they can't find elsewhere, specifically the lot size, the privacy, the setting, and the lifestyle access. Without that case built clearly in the marketing, buyers at \$1,995,000 moved on before scheduling a showing.

\$1,995,000

List Price

\$904/sqft

Price Per Sq. Ft.

None

HOA Fees

A relaunch needs to lead with what actually differentiates this property: the grounds, the oaks, the cul-de-sac privacy, and the trail and community access that Lafayette buyers at this price range are specifically looking for. The kitchen and interior updates support the number. The setting justifies it.

MARKET FORENSICS: WHY IT DIDN'T SELL

Every expired listing has a story. Here's what the listing history tells us about what held this one back, and what a different strategy would have done.

Friction #1: 69 Days Without a Strategy Shift

After 69 days on the market, buyer psychology had already done its damage. Past the 45-day mark, buyers stop asking whether a home is worth the price and start asking what everyone else noticed that they might have missed. At \$1,995,000 in Lafayette, that skepticism is costly. The buyers who could afford this home and had the most interest likely saw it in the first three weeks. The remaining six weeks weren't generating new demand, they were confirming doubt. The strategy didn't adapt, and the listing eventually came off the market without a sale or a visible pivot.

* THE BRIGHTWORK DIFFERENCE

BrightWork uses the Final Offer platform to surface real buyer demand in a structured, transparent format, so sellers can see exactly where interest stands and make informed decisions before the clock runs out on the listing period.

Friction #2: \$904/Sqft With a Case That Was Never Made

At \$904 per square foot, this home is priced at the upper end of the Lafayette premium range. That number is defensible. The half-acre lot, the park-like grounds, the mature oak canopy, the cul-de-sac position, and the proximity to Las Trampas and the Lafayette-Orinda Trail all support a premium. But buyers doing side-by-side comparisons on Zillow and homes.com need to understand specifically what they're getting at that number. The listing description leaned on adjectives rather than differentiation. Words like 'fabulous,' 'seamlessly,' and 'beautifully reimaged' appear where concrete details about the setting, the lot, and the lifestyle access should have been. Buyers at this price point are careful. They need to be convinced before they drive out.

* THE BRIGHTWORK DIFFERENCE

BrightWork's homes.com premium membership delivers significantly higher view counts and broader distribution than a standard agent account, putting this property in front of buyers who are actively researching Lafayette before they've found what they're looking for.

Friction #3: The Outdoor Setting Was a Footnote, Not the Story

A 21,340-square-foot lot with majestic oaks, meandering pathways, multiple patio and deck spaces, and picturesque views is the kind of asset that Lafayette buyers at \$1,995,000 specifically come looking for. It's not a supporting detail. It's the reason someone chooses this home over a newer, smaller-lot alternative nearby. Standard MLS photography almost never captures what a lot like this actually feels like. Ground-level angles, flat lighting, and a quick pass through the yard leave the canopy, the sense of scale, and the privacy completely invisible to online buyers. This setting needed to be the first thing buyers experienced, not the last paragraph of the listing remarks.

* THE BRIGHTWORK DIFFERENCE

BrightWork's Sky Tour captures the lot position, oak canopy, and park-like setting from above in a way that no ground photography or satellite image can replicate, giving buyers the visual depth to understand what they're getting before they ever schedule a showing.

POSITIONING ANALYSIS

Metric	3348 Walnut Ln	Lafayette Market Context
Price per Sq. Ft.	\$904/sqft	Premium tier: \$850–\$920/sqft
Lot / Setting	21,340 sqft, cul-de-sac, oak canopy, park-like grounds	Typical Lafayette lot: 8,000–12,000 sqft
Architectural Character	Farmhouse style, high-quality updates, custom built-ins, wood-burning fireplace	Standard 1960s–1970s updated ranch or split-level
Premium Features	Chef's kitchen with breakfast bar, indoor-outdoor flow, multiple patios and deck, trail and swim club access	Standard floor plan, basic outdoor space
HOA	None	Varies; most Lafayette single-family homes have no HOA

The verdict: At \$904/sqft versus a benchmark range of \$850-\$920/sqft, this home sits near the upper end of that range. At \$904 per square foot, this home sits near the upper end of Lafayette's premium range. The lot size, setting, and architectural updates support that position. What the listing period revealed is that buyers weren't given the tools to see the case clearly, especially the outdoor setting and lifestyle access that separate this property from comparably priced homes on smaller lots. A relaunch built around those differentiators, with media that actually shows the grounds, gives this home a much stronger chance of landing where the fundamentals say it should.

THE RELAUNCH STRATEGY: 3 PILLARS

We don't re-list this home. We relaunch it with new media, a narrative that finally does it justice, and distribution designed for the buyer it deserves.

Pillar I - Build the Visual Case for the Lot Before a Buyer Drives Out

The 21,340-square-foot setting with mature oaks, pathways, and multi-level outdoor spaces is the most compelling differentiator this home has. It's also the asset most invisible in standard MLS photography. A relaunch starts with media that does the setting justice, including aerial coverage that shows the lot scale, canopy, and cul-de-sac position in a way buyers can actually feel. BrightWork's Sky Tour is purpose-built for exactly this kind of property. When buyers can experience the grounds from above before they ever schedule a showing, the in-person visit confirms rather than discovers.

Pillar II - Write a Listing Description That Earns the Price

At \$904 per square foot, buyers are doing careful comparisons, and the listing remarks are often the deciding factor in whether a showing gets scheduled at all. The previous description had the right instincts but relied on adjectives where specific detail was needed. A relaunched listing leads with the cul-de-sac privacy, the trail access to Las Trampas and the Lafayette-Orinda Trail, the half-acre park-like grounds, and the community context that Lafayette families at this price range are specifically seeking. BrightWork's listing narrative is written the way a great buyer's agent describes a home to a motivated client, because that's who reads it first.

Pillar III - Put This Home in Front of the Right Buyer Pool Before They Find Something Else

The buyers most likely to pay \$1,995,000 for this property are relocating from San Francisco or Oakland, shopping online first and hard, and looking for exactly the combination of lot size, trail access, and top schools that Walnut Lane delivers. Waiting for them to stumble onto a standard MLS listing isn't a strategy. BrightWork's geo-targeted digital campaigns reach those buyers while they are actively researching Lafayette, before they have found what they are looking for. Combined with the off-market private buyer list at offmarket.brightworkrealty.com, this home gets seen by the right people at the right moment.

A DIFFERENT OPTION: THE QUIET LISTING

Sell Without the Disruption

A traditional listing puts a sign in your yard, opens your door to strangers every weekend, and puts your home's history on public record. For a home that already went through one listing cycle, there's a better starting point.

BrightWork maintains an active private buyer list through our off-market platform. These are Bay Area buyers who've opted in specifically to receive property alerts before anything hits Zillow. They're motivated, pre-qualified, and they believe an off-market home represents a real opportunity, which means they engage seriously.

- * **No public days on market.** The prior listing history stays private. A new buyer sees none of it.
- * **No sign, no open houses, no disruption.** The sale is a private conversation between a motivated buyer and a motivated seller.
- * **Option to go public anytime.** If the right off-market offer doesn't materialize in an agreed window, we transition directly into a full relaunch strategy with no time lost.

* HOW IT WORKS

We alert our private buyer list through offmarket.brightworkrealty.com - Bay Area buyers specifically seeking properties before they go public. If a serious match emerges within the agreed window, we negotiate and close privately. If not, we launch the full relaunch strategy immediately, with clean momentum and no days-on-market exposure.

TIMELINE: THE BRIGHTWORK SMART WAY

Phase 1 - Pre-Market Preparation (Weeks 1–2)

Staging, full media production, and a Coming Soon campaign - or a quiet listing launch to our private buyer network, depending on your preference.

Phase 2 - Strategic Launch (Week 3)

Thursday launch on Zillow Showcase with the full media package in premium placement. Targeted SF/Oakland digital ads go live the same day.

Phase 3 - Momentum Management (Weeks 4–5)

Active follow-up on every save, inquiry, and open house visitor. Final Offer gives serious buyers a transparent channel to submit competitive offers.

Phase 4 - The Close (Weeks 6–7)

We engineer competition, not just field offers. Our process keeps both sides of the transaction moving cleanly toward a close.

WHY BRIGHTWORK REALTY ADVOCATES

- * **Deep local roots:** 45+ years in Moraga, Lafayette, and Orinda. Ground-level knowledge of what buyers in each community are actually paying for.
- * **Premium marketing as a baseline:** Cinematic photography, floor plans, 3D tours, and Sky Tours on every listing. Not a luxury add-on.
- * **Portal dominance:** Zillow Showcase and homes.com premium placement. More views, enhanced listing pages, all leads to your team.
- * **Modern offer tools:** Final Offer gives buyers a transparent path to engage and gives you real-time demand data in one place.
- * **True advocacy:** We don't re-list homes. We forensically review what went wrong and rebuild the strategy from the ground up.

This home has real assets that the market never got to properly evaluate. That's a correctable problem. The window to correct it is still open.

Ready to talk? brightworkrealty.com · (925) 255-9727

Scan to see what a relaunch looks like for your home: relaunch.brightworkrealty.com

Important Notice

If you have entered into a listing agreement or active representation agreement with a licensed real estate agent in connection with this property, please disregard this mailing.

BrightWork Realty Advocates is a licensed real estate team operated by Ben Olsen, REALTOR, California DRE License #01409268. This communication is not intended to solicit properties currently listed for sale or under active representation.

The market analysis and strategic observations contained in this report are based on publicly available listing data and BrightWork's professional assessment of market conditions. They are not a formal appraisal and should not be relied upon as a certified valuation.

All property data referenced in this report was obtained from public records and MLS history. BrightWork Realty Advocates makes no warranty as to the accuracy of third-party data sources.

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THE BRIGHTWORK ADVANTAGE

- Buy Before You Sell
- BrightFlip Pre-Sale Improvements
- Final Offer Platform
- Zillow Showcase + homes.com Premium
- Off-Market Network
- Built to Close Clean

YOUR LISTING ADVISOR

Ben Olsen

Founding Partner | REALTOR · BrightWork Realty Advocates · DRE# 02014153

Ben founded BrightWork on a specific premise: the best outcomes are built before a home ever lists. With twenty years serving the East Bay's most competitive submarkets, he's developed a clear point of view on what separates a sale that closes well from one that doesn't, and the preparation, marketing, and negotiation strategy to act on it.

He entered the workforce at 14 in construction, a background that shapes how he thinks about pre-sale decisions, disclosure strategy, and what buyers actually scrutinize at inspection. That's a different lens than most agents carry into a listing consultation.

His approach to marketing is built on the same logic. Every campaign is designed for your home's specific buyer, not the average buyer. Portal strategy, campaign integration, and buyer targeting aren't add-ons at BrightWork. They're the baseline. Pre-sale prep, real fixes, and full disclosure before the home lists. The preparation is the negotiation.

20+

YEARS SERVING
LAMORINDA

\$1B+

PROPERTIES
SOLD

1,000+

BUYERS &
SELLERS

WHY HE SENT YOU THIS PACKET

When a listing expires, Ben reviews it. Not to pitch you, but because after enough of them, the pattern of what goes wrong becomes clear. If you received this analysis, he looked at your specific property and has a specific point of view about what happened. That's the conversation he's offering. No listing agreement on the table. Just a review. He'll also walk you through programs that turn seller constraints into options, and show you what a transaction designed to get everyone to the closing table feeling good actually looks like.

Why BrightWork Realty Advocates

Rooted in Lamorinda since 1977. BrightWork is built on the premise that the best outcomes start before a home ever lists. An orchestrated campaign designed for your home's buyer, not the average buyer. Programs that turn seller constraints into options. Transactions designed so everyone gets to the closing table feeling good.

That's The Smart Way to Real Estate.

EIGHT REASONS SMART SELLERS CHOOSE BRIGHTWORK

01 Superior Presentation

Professional photography, floor plans, 3D tours, and Sky Tours on every listing. Not the luxury package. The baseline.

02 Premium Portal Presence

Zillow Showcase and premium homes.com membership. Higher view counts, better placement, and buyer inquiries that route to your listing team.

03 Integrated Campaigns

Every sign, mailer, and open house connects to a digital system. Curious neighbors become trackable leads.

04 Modern Offer Management

Real-time portal data guides pricing decisions. Final Offer platform for properties with strong multi-offer potential.

05 Financial Tools & Capital Programs

Capital to fund pre-sale improvements with no out-of-pocket cost until close. Plus programs that remove the timing trap entirely.

06 Off-Market Strategy

A private list of serious Bay Area buyers. Test demand quietly or gain early access before properties hit MLS.

07 Advocacy for Unsold Homes

When a home hasn't sold, we don't re-list at a lower price. We conduct a forensic review and relaunch with a rebuilt strategy.

08 Built to Close Clean

Pre-sale prep, real fixes, and full disclosure to every buyer before the house lists. He structures listings to attract the best first offers from a position no one can argue with. The preparation is the negotiation.

BrightWork has served Lamorinda since 1977. Over \$1 billion in local real estate sold.

Ben Olsen | (925) 255-9727 | ben@brightworkrealty.com | brightworkrealty.com

Not Every Home Needs a Public Launch.

For sellers who need privacy, flexibility, or a different kind of timing — BrightWork has a smarter first step.

Most agents know one approach: list on the MLS, hit the portals, hold open houses. That works for many homes. For sellers who need privacy, flexibility, or more control over timing, BrightWork offers a structured, documented private path to the right buyer — built on relationships in Lamorinda that go back to 1977.

OFF MARKET SELLING HAS ITS BENEFITS

Your Home, Your Timing, No Pressure

No days-on-market counter. No public record. No nosy neighbors. Your home stays entirely private until you choose otherwise, and if you do go public later, you start fresh, with a clean slate and zero wasted days behind you.

Buyers Who Are Actually Ready

BrightWork maintains a curated list of serious, pre-qualified Bay Area buyers who have asked to be notified about Lamorinda properties. They are not browsing Zillow. Every showing is by appointment, with someone who qualifies and is genuinely interested.

Real Feedback Before You Commit

An off-market phase gives you genuine buyer response before you decide whether to close privately or step into a full MLS campaign. Either way, you move forward with real data and momentum, not day-one guesswork.

BrightWork's network of private buyers and collaborative realtor relationships has served Lamorinda since 1977.

Over \$1 billion in local real estate sold.

Deep relationships in Moraga, Lafayette, and Orinda.

WHO THE PRIVATE PATH SERVES

The Privacy-First Seller

No public listings, no open houses, and no days-on-market counter visible to buyers and agents, for whatever reason, professional or personal.

The Seller Still Preparing

Test genuine demand while staging or repairs are still underway, without burning days on market before you are ready.

The Strategically Timed Seller

Your next move depends on how this one closes. Control the sequence rather than react to a public countdown clock.

The Seller Testing the Waters

Get real buyer feedback before committing to a full public launch — or decide you do not need one at all.

Your home. Your timeline. Your terms.

Ready to find out whether the private path is the right first step?

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